

HB 2096 -- STATE FUNDS FOR REGIONAL PLANNING COMMISSIONS

SPONSOR: Farnan

COMMITTEE ACTION: Voted "Do Pass" by the Standing Committee on Local Government by a vote of 14 to 0. Voted "Do Pass" by the Standing Committee on Rules-Administrative by a vote of 9 to 0.

Under current law, state funds for the East-West Gateway Coordinating Council and for the Mid-America Regional Council are not to exceed \$65,000 and state funds for other regional planning commissions must not exceed \$25,000. This bill changes the sums to \$130,000 and \$50,000.

Additionally, the bill removes the regional planning commissions of Show-Me, Missouri Valley, Ozark Gateway, ABCD, and Lakes County and adds Harry S. Truman, MO-Kan, Pioneer Trails, and Southwest Missouri.

Beginning July 1, 2027, the maximum grant amount for each regional planning commission will be adjusted with the Consumer Price Index.

This bill is similar to HB 837 (2025).

PROPOSERS: Supporters say that the statutory caps being modified in this bill have been unchanged for a long time. These commissions have been asked to do more with less for too long. Planning commissions work closely with county and municipal governments and helping the commissions would also help these governments.

Testifying in person for the bill were Representative Farnan; Arnie Dienoff; Jeremy Tanz, Southeast Missouri Regional Planning Commission; and Missouri Municipal League.

OPPOSERS: There was no opposition voiced to the committee.

Written testimony has been submitted for this bill. The full written testimony and witnesses testifying online can be found under Testimony on the bill page on the House website.